25 **‘fondness for wine, which he was unable to give up’:** Parodi and Wannell, ‘The Earliest Datable Mughal Painting’ available at <https://www.asianart.com/articles/parodi/index.html> [accessed: 2 January 2020].

25 **Dust Muhammad painted a masterpiece of refinement:** For more information, see Laura E. Parodis, ‘Tracing the Rise of Mughal Portraiture’ in *Portraiture in South Asia Since the Mughals*, edited by Crispen Branfoot, I. B. Tauris, 2018.

26 **‘a well educated prince combined the best qualities of a man’:** Faruqui, *Princes of the Mughal Empire, 1504–1719*, p. 78.

26 **‘acute astrologers and time-knowing astrolabe-conners’:** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, p. 519.

26 **‘scholar of God’s school’:** Ibid.

26 **‘continually giving his attention to that wondrous creature the camel’:** Ibid., p. 589.

27 **Akbar is shown presenting a painting he has made to his father:** Golestan Palace Library, Tehran.

27 **being due to a dyslexic condition:** Smart, ‘Akbar, Illiterate Genius’, p. 108.

28 **‘the minds of those present were set at rest’:** Faruqui, *Princes of the Mughal Empire*, p. 72.

28 **‘the kindness and affection which she showed to me’:** Quoted in Moosvi, *Episodes in the Life of Akbar*, p. 12.

28 **‘would to Heaven that merciless sword’:** Gulbadan, *Humāyūn-Nāma*, p. 198.

28–29 **‘The marriage of a young child is displeasing to the Almighty’:** Abu’l Fazl, ‘Happy Sayings of Akbar’, *Ain-i Akbari*, Part 5, Vol. 3, translated by H. S. Jarrett, Calcutta: Royal Asiatic Society, 1894.

29 **Sit not idle ‘tis not the time for play:** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 1, p. 317.

29 **‘God be praised that things which cannot be replaced are safe’:** Kavita Singh, *Real Birds in Imagined Gardens: Mughal Painting between Persia and Europe*, Los Angeles: Getty Publications, 2017, p. 11.

29 **‘was ideally a figure of fierce authority’:** Faruqui, *Princes of the Mughal Empire*, p. 76.

30 **‘Brotherly custom has nothing to do with ruling and reigning’:** Gulbadan, *Humāyūn-Nāma*, p. 201.

30 **‘disputed among themselves who was to perform the cruel act’:** Jauhar, *The Tazkereh Al Vakiāt*, p. 105.

30 **‘seeing the prince in such pain and distress’:** Ibid., p. 107.

31 **‘pleasantly floated down the river to Pyshavir’:** Jauhar, *The Tazkereh Al Vakiāt*, p. 109.

31 **‘and was so delighted and happy’:** Ibid., p. 110.

31 **‘Alas that the Emperor Humayun died so early’:** *Akbarnama*; ‘Happy Sayings of Akbar’, *Ain-i Akbari*, Part 5, Vol. 3.

32 **‘Before this,’ writes historian Iqtidar Alam Khan’:** Iqtidar Alam Khan, ‘The Nobility under Akbar and the Development of His Religious Policy, 1560–80’, *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society of Great Britain and Ireland*, No. 1/2, April 1968, p. 35.

32 **‘My father esteemed much things like this’:** Sir Edward Maclagan, *The Jesuits and the Great Mogul*, London: Burns, Oats and Washbourne Ltd, 1932, p. 231.

32 **‘the range of colours used suggests’:** Singh, *Real Birds in Imagined Gardens*, p. 19.

33 **‘became as much a master of this art as masters of a single art and craft are’:** Wheeler M. Thackston (trans.), *The History of Akbar*, Vol. 2, New Delhi: Harvard University Press, 2016, p. 383.

33 **‘eccentric dilettante’ of modern rhetoric:** See Moin, *Millennial Sovereign.*

33 **‘These included…division of the kingdom’s administration’:** Eaton, *India in the Persianate Age*, p. 214.

34 **‘was upset beyond human imagination’:** Thackston (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 2, p. 408.